IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 30

TRADITIONAL FOOD

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- What is your favourite food?
- Do you like cooking?
- Is food an important part of your culture?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a traditional food from your country.

You should say:

- what it is
- how it is made
- when people eat it
- why you like it

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Are traditional dishes disappearing?
- Why do people enjoy trying foreign food?
- Is home cooking becoming less common?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “traditional food” card

- A traditional food from your country
- A meal you enjoyed at a restaurant
- A dish you can cook well
- A special meal you had with your family
- A food you tried for the first time
- A festival with special food
- A healthy meal you like
- A snack or street food you enjoy

What the dish is → **How** it is made → **When** people eat it → **Why** you like it

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing the dish

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 mouth-watering

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘iz chuchituvchi, ishtahani ochuvchi • *looking or smelling so delicious that you want to eat it at once*

BAND 8 STORY

The smell of **mouth-watering** samsa drifted from the tandir as I walked past the bazaar. I couldn’t resist, so I bought three hot ones and ate them right there on the pavement, burning my fingers.

≈ **appetising** — ishtaha ochuvchi

≈ **tempting** — vasvasaga soluvchi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hidi yoki ko‘rinishi juda yoqimli taomni tasvirlaydi: a mouth-watering smell/aroma/dish. Sifat sifatida ot oldidan keladi. Part 2 da taom tavsifi uchun a’lo.

Namuna gap: The table was full of **mouth-watering** dishes, and I didn’t know where to start.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 rich in flavour

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ta’mi boy, mazali • *having a deep, strong and full taste*

BAND 8 STORY

Traditional shurpa is incredibly **rich in flavour** because the meat simmers for hours with vegetables. After one spoonful on a cold winter evening, I felt warm from head to toe.

≈ **full of flavour** — ta’mga boy

≈ **packed with flavour** — ta’mga to‘la

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘be rich in + noun’ (flavour, vitamins, history). Taom ta’mini tasvirlashda ‘tasty’ dan ancha yaxshi. Part 2 da ‘rich in flavour’ va ‘rich in tradition’ deb ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Uzbek bread is **rich in flavour** because it’s baked in a clay oven.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 a hearty meal

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

to‘yimli, mazali ovqat • *a large, satisfying meal that fills you up*

BAND 8 STORY

After a long hike in the mountains, we sat down to **a hearty meal** of lagman and fresh bread. Everyone was starving, and nobody said a word until the bowls were empty.

≈ **a filling meal** — to‘ydiradigan ovqat

≈ **a substantial dish** — to‘yimli taom

Qachon ishlatiladi: Katta, to‘ydiradigan ovqat haqida: a hearty meal/breakfast/soup. Salqin ob-havo yoki charchoqdan keyingi ovqat uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: My grandmother always prepares **a hearty meal** for the whole family on Sundays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 piping hot

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda issiq, qaynoq • *very hot, usually said about food just served*

BAND 8 STORY

The plov arrived **piping hot**, with steam rising from the golden rice. I was so eager that I burnt my tongue on the first bite, but it was totally worth it.

≈ **freshly cooked** — yangi pishirilgan

≈ **straight from the oven** — tandirdan yangi uzilgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ovqat yoki ichimlik haqida: served piping hot. Ko‘pincha ‘served’ yoki ‘arrive’ bilan. Taomning yangiligi va issiqligini bildiradi.

Namuna gap: Samsa tastes best when it comes **piping hot** from the tandir.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 slow-cooked

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

sekin, past olovda pishirilgan • *cooked gently for a long time so the flavour develops*

BAND 8 STORY

My mother’s **slow-cooked** dimlama needs nearly three hours, but the vegetables and meat become so soft that you hardly need to chew. It’s the perfect meal for a family reunion.

≈ **simmered for hours** — soatlab damlangan

≈ **cooked over low heat** — past olovda pishirilgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sifat: slow-cooked meat/stew/beef. Uzoq pishiriladigan milliy taomlarga mos. Sabr va mehnatni ta’kidlashda ishlating.

Namuna gap: The **slow-cooked** lamb was so tender that it fell off the bone.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 melt in your mouth

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘izda erib ketmoq • *to be so soft and tasty that it seems to dissolve when you eat it*

BAND 8 STORY

The fresh samsa from our neighbourhood bakery **melts in your mouth**. The pastry is crisp, the lamb inside is juicy, and I usually end up eating three before I even sit down.

≈ **be incredibly tender** — juda yumshoq bo‘lmoq

≈ **taste heavenly** — jannat ta’mini bermoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘melt in your mouth’ – yumshoq, mazali taomlar haqida (go‘sht, shirinlik). Fe’l ibora: It melts in your mouth. Part 2 da ta’mni jonli tasvirlaydi.

Namuna gap: The halva was so smooth that it simply **melted in my mouth**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 freshly baked

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

yangi pishirilgan (non, pirog) • *just made in an oven and still warm*

BAND 8 STORY

Nothing beats the smell of **freshly baked** non early in the morning. My grandfather used to wake me up to get some from the local bakery, and we ate it warm with butter and honey.

≈ **straight out of the oven** — pechdan yangi chiqqan

≈ **oven-fresh** — yangi pishgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Non, shirinlik uchun: freshly baked bread/cakes. 'freshly' + p.p. – freshly cooked/ground/squeezed. Hid va xotirani bog'lashda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: I love the smell of **freshly baked** bread drifting through our street.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 aromatic spices

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xushbo'y ziravorlar • *spices that have a strong, pleasant smell*

BAND 8 STORY

Our traditional dishes are flavoured with **aromatic spices** such as cumin and coriander. When my mum fries them in hot oil, the whole house smells wonderful, and my brother always sneaks into the kitchen.

≈ **fragrant herbs** — xushbo'y o'tlar

≈ **a blend of spices** — ziravorlar aralashmasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ziravorlar haqida: aromatic/fragrant spices, a pinch of spices. 'aromatic' = hidli. Milliy taomlardagi zira, kashnich va zafaron haqida gapirishda mos.

Namuna gap: The dish gets its unique taste from **aromatic spices** like cumin and saffron.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 tender meat

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

yumshoq go'sht • *meat that is soft and easy to cut or chew*

BAND 8 STORY

What makes our shashlik special is the **tender meat** marinated overnight with onions. On the first bite, the juices run down your chin, and everyone around the grill goes quiet with satisfaction.

≈ **juicy meat** — shirali go'sht

≈ **succulent lamb** — mazali, shirali qo'y go'shti

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'tender' go'sht haqida: tender beef/lamb/chicken. 'soft' emas, 'tender' deymiz. Part 2 da go'shtli milliy taomlarni tasvirlashda mos.

Namuna gap: The **tender meat** in the dish simply falls apart when you touch it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 a staple food

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

asosiy oziq-ovqat • *a basic food that people eat regularly*

BAND 8 STORY

Rice and bread are **staple foods** in Uzbek homes, and we eat them almost every day. No matter how fancy a dinner is, there will always be a basket of fresh non on the table.

≈ **a dietary mainstay** — asosiy ovqat

≈ **an everyday dish** — kundalik taom

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mamlakat yoki madaniyatning asosiy ovqati haqida: a staple food/ the staple of the diet. Part 1 'Food in your culture' uchun mos. Rasmiy-neytral.

Namuna gap: Potatoes are a **staple food** in many European countries.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 from scratch

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

noldan, tayyor mahsulotsiz • *using basic ingredients and not ready-made products*

BAND 8 STORY
My grandmother makes everything **from scratch**, even the noodles for lagman. She rolls the dough by hand and cuts it into thin strips, and the result tastes nothing like the shop-bought kind.

≈ **using fresh ingredients** — yangi mahsulotlardan

≈ **by hand** — qo'lda

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'from scratch' – tayyor yarim fabrikat ishlatmay pishirish. 'make/bake/cook from scratch'. Part 1 'Do you like cooking?' va Part 3 da keng ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: I bake bread **from scratch** because the taste is incomparable.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 a secret recipe

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

maxfiy retsept • *a method for cooking something that only a few people know*

BAND 8 STORY
Every plov master in our city claims to have **a secret recipe**. Mine is a particular type of rice and a handful of barberries, and he only shared it after I had watched him for two years.

≈ **a closely guarded recipe** — sir saqlanadigan retsept

≈ **a special technique** — maxsus usul

Qachon ishlatiladi: Retsept sirini aytib o'tish uchun: have/keep/share a secret recipe. Part 2 da taom hikoyasini qiziqarli qilish uchun ishlatiladi. 'guarded secret' ham mumkin.

Namuna gap: The restaurant is famous for its **secret recipe**, which has never been written down.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 simmer gently

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

sekin qaynatmoq, past olovda damlamoq • *to cook liquid slowly just below boiling point*

BAND 8 STORY
Let the soup **simmer gently** for about an hour, and the meat will become soft and full of flavour. My mum says the secret is patience, and she never lets me turn up the heat.

≈ **cook on low heat** — past olovda pishirmoq

≈ **let it bubble slowly** — sekin qaynashiga qo'ymoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) g'azabi/hissiy ichida qaynamoq — He sat in silence, **simmering** with anger.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Retsept tushuntirishda: simmer gently/slowly for an hour. 'boil' dan farqli, past olov. Part 2 da 'how it is made' bandi uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: You should **simmer** the sauce **gently** until it thickens.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 passed down from generation to generation

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

avloddan-avlodga o‘tib kelgan • *given from older family members to younger ones over many years*

BAND 8 STORY

This recipe has been **passed down from generation to generation** in our family. My great-grandmother taught my grandmother, who taught my mother, and now I’m learning each step from her.

≈ **handed down** — meros bo‘lib o‘tgan

≈ **inherited from ancestors** — ajdodlardan meros qolgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odatda passiv: has been passed down from generation to generation. Qisqa shakli: handed down. Part 2 va 3 da an’ana va merosni aytishda juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Many customs have been **passed down from generation to generation** in my village.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 a family recipe

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

oilaviy retsept • *a way of cooking a dish that belongs to your family*

BAND 8 STORY

A family recipe is more than a list of ingredients; it’s a connection with the past. My aunt keeps ours in an old notebook with oil stains and little notes in the margins.

≈ **a time-honoured recipe** — asrlar sinovidan o‘tgan retsept

≈ **a traditional recipe** — an’anaviy retsept

Qachon ishlatiladi: Oila, xotira bilan bog‘liq mavzularda: a treasured family recipe. Part 1 va Part 2 da juda yaxshi. Hissiy qiymatni ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: My mother’s **family recipe** for manti is known in the whole neighbourhood.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 season to taste

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

ta’mga qarab ziravor/tuz qo‘shmoq • *to add salt or spices until the food tastes right for you*

BAND 8 STORY

At the end, my mum always tastes the soup and **seasons it to taste**. She never measures anything, just adds a pinch of salt and a bit of pepper until it’s perfect.

≈ **adjust the seasoning** — ziravorini sozlamoq

≈ **add salt and pepper** — tuz va murch qo‘shmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Retsept uslubida: season to taste, season with salt. Qanday pishirilishini tushuntirishda ‘how it is made’ bandi uchun foydali.

Namuna gap: Once the stew is ready, **season** it **to taste** with salt and black pepper.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 marinate overnight

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

tunda marinadlab qo‘ymoq • *to leave meat in a flavoured sauce for many hours before cooking*

BAND 8 STORY

The secret to good kebab is to **marinate** the meat **overnight** with onions and spices. By the time it hits the grill the next day, it is soft and bursting with flavour.

≈ **soak in a marinade** — marinadga solib qo‘ymoq

≈ **leave to infuse** — ta‘m o‘tishi uchun qoldirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Go‘shtni oldindan tayyorlash uchun: marinate (meat) in/with + for hours/overnight. Retsept bayonida foydali. Shashlik haqidagi javoblarga yaxshi mos.

Namuna gap: Remember to **marinate** the chicken **overnight** for the best flavour.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 knead the dough

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

xamir yoymoq, qorishtirmoq • *to press and fold dough with your hands to make it smooth*

BAND 8 STORY

On Sunday mornings, I help my mum **knead the dough** for traditional bread. It’s tiring for my arms, but the smell of warm flour and the way she hums while working make it a special memory.

≈ **work the dough** — xamirni ishlamoq

≈ **roll out the dough** — xamirni yoymoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Non, manti, lagman tayyorlash tavsifida: knead the dough by hand for ten minutes. Qo‘lda tayyorlash mehnatini ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: You have to **knead the dough** for at least ten minutes until it’s smooth.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 stir constantly

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

tinmay aralashtirib turmoq • *to keep mixing food all the time while it cooks*

BAND 8 STORY

To make the halva smooth, you must **stir constantly**. My aunt once told me that if you stop for a minute, it burns, and I learned that lesson the hard way.

≈ **keep stirring** — aralashtirishda davom etmoq

≈ **mix continuously** — to‘xtovsiz aralashtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Retsept ko‘rsatmasi: stir constantly/occasionally/gently. Pishirish jarayonini aniq tushuntirishda ishlating. Part 2 ‘how it is made’.

Namuna gap: You need to **stir constantly** to prevent the sauce from sticking.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 cook over an open fire

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

ochiq olovda pishirmoq • *to prepare food directly on flames or hot coals*

BAND 8 STORY

Nothing compares to meat **cooked over an open fire**. During our camping trips, my uncle grills skewers on charcoal, and the smoky smell makes everyone gather around, hungry and happy.

≈ **grill over charcoal** — ko'mirda qovurmoq

≈ **roast on a fire** — olovda kuydirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tabiat, sayr va kebab haqida: cook/grill over an open fire/ charcoal. 'over' predlogiga e'tibor bering. Chaikhana va piknik mavzusiga mos.

Namuna gap: Meat **cooked over an open fire** has a smoky flavour that I adore.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 gather around the table

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

dasturxon atrofiga yig‘ilmoq • *to come together and sit around a table to eat*

BAND 8 STORY
On holidays the whole family **gathers around the table**, and my grandfather says a short prayer before we begin. It’s the only time of the year when all the cousins sit together in one place.

≈ **sit down together** — birga o‘tirmoq

≈ **get together for a meal** — ovqat uchun yig‘ilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Oilaviy ovqat va birdamlik haqida: gather around the table/ the dastarkhan. Madaniyat mavzusida juda yaxshi. Part 1 va Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: Families still **gather around the table** on special holidays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 dig in

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ovqatga kirishmoq, tortinmay yeya boshlamoq • *to start eating eagerly*

BAND 8 STORY
As soon as my grandmother put the steaming plov on the table, my cousins shouted **dig in**, and everyone reached for a spoon. Within minutes the plate was nearly empty, and the room was full of happy chatter.

≈ **tuck in** — ishtaha bilan yeya boshlamoq

≈ **help yourself** — o‘zingiz oling

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy: ‘Dig in!’ = Marhamat, yeyavering. Mehmonlarni taklif qilishda yoki ovqat boshlanishini tasvirlashda. Rasmiy yozuvda ishlatilmaydi.

Namuna gap: As soon as the food arrived, we all **dug in**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 second helpings

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ikkinchi marta olish, qo‘shimcha porsiya • *an extra portion of food you take after the first*

BAND 8 STORY
At my grandmother’s house, you can’t say no to **second helpings**. She keeps adding more food to your plate, and refusing is considered rude, so I always leave the table completely stuffed.

≈ **another portion** — yana bir porsiya

≈ **seconds** — qo‘shimcha ovqat

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘have/go for second helpings’ – ikkinchi marta ovqat olish. Mehmondorchilik odatlari haqida. Norasmiy va iliq. Ko‘pincha ko‘plik shaklida.

Namuna gap: I couldn’t resist going back for **second helpings** of the delicious pilaf.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 a festive spread

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

bayramona dasturxon • *a large selection of food prepared for a celebration*

BAND 8 STORY

On Navruz our table is covered with **a festive spread**: sumalak, samsa, fruits and sweets. Visitors keep arriving all day, and my mother is always at the centre, smiling and refilling the teapot.

≈ **a lavish feast** — dabdabali ziyofat

≈ **a table full of treats** — noz-ne'matlarga boy dasturxon

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bayram va to'y dasturxonini tasvirlash: lay out/prepare a festive spread. Madaniy bayramlar mavzusida Part 2 da ajoyib.

Namuna gap: My aunt prepared **a festive spread** for the whole family.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 the centrepiece of the meal

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

dasturxonning asosiy taomi • *the most important dish on the table*

BAND 8 STORY

At weddings, plov is always **the centrepiece of the meal**. A huge kazan arrives to the table, everyone watches the cook lift the lid, and the room fills with the smell of cumin and meat.

≈ **the star of the show** — asosiy diqqat markazi

≈ **the main attraction** — asosiy tomosha

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'the centrepiece of + ot' – eng muhim narsa. To'y va bayram taomlari haqida. Metafora sifatida ham: the centrepiece of the celebration. Britaniya imlosi: centrepiece.

Namuna gap: Roast lamb is **the centrepiece of the meal** at many festivals.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 work up an appetite

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishtaha ochmoq, ishtahani ochtirmoq • *to do something active so that you feel hungry*

BAND 8 STORY

We hiked for four hours in the mountains, and I certainly **worked up an appetite**. When we finally reached the chaikhana, the smell of fresh lagman made me feel faint with hunger.

≈ **get hungry** — ochikmoq

≈ **build up a hunger** — ishtaha paydo qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Faol harakatdan keyin ochikishni aytish: work up an appetite. 'work' o'tgan zamonda 'worked'. Norasmiy. Hikoyada kulgi yaratish uchun.

Namuna gap: A long walk will help you **work up an appetite** before dinner.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 a sweet tooth

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shirinlikka ishtiyoq • *a strong liking for sweet food*

BAND 8 STORY

I have **a sweet tooth**, so I can never skip the halva after the main course. My grandmother knows it, and she always saves a small plate for me in the kitchen cupboard.

≈ **a taste for desserts** — shirinliklarga mayl

≈ **love sweet things** — shirinlikni yaxshi ko'rmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'have a sweet tooth' – shirinlikka o'ch bo'lmoq. Idiom; faqat 'have' bilan. Part 1 'favourite food' savoliga shaxsiy javob uchun ajoyib.

Namuna gap: My brother has **a sweet tooth** and eats chocolate every day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 mark a special occasion

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

muhim voqeani nishonlamoq • *to celebrate an important event in a special way*

BAND 8 STORY

In Uzbekistan, we **mark special occasions** with a big meal, usually plov or manti. When my sister graduated, the neighbours brought dishes too, so the table was overflowing with food.

≈ **celebrate an event** — tadbirni nishonlamoq

≈ **commemorate** — xotirlamoq, yodga olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom va bayram o'rtasidagi aloqa: mark an occasion/ a milestone with + food. 'special occasion' juda keng tarqalgan. Part 1 va 3 da bayramlar haqida.

Namuna gap: Families often **mark special occasions** by cooking traditional dishes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 finger-licking good

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

barmoq tishlatadigan darajada mazali • *so tasty that you want to lick your fingers*

BAND 8 STORY

The fried chicken at the roadside stall was absolutely **finger-licking good**. We ate it standing up, with greasy hands, and decided that the long drive was worth it just for that one meal.

≈ **delicious** — mazali

≈ **scrumptious** — juda mazali

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy, kulgili ibora: be finger-licking good. Yo'l bo'yi taomlari, kebab yoki qovurilgan ovqatlar haqida. Rasmiy bo'lmagan nutqda foydali.

Namuna gap: The kebab was **finger-licking good**, and I ate far too much.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 comfort food

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

ko‘ngilga yaqin, yupatuvchi taom • *food that makes you feel better and reminds you of home*

BAND 8 STORY

When I’m homesick or stressed, my **comfort food** is a bowl of my mum’s chicken soup. One spoonful takes me back to the kitchen of my childhood, and instantly I feel safer.

≈ **soul food** — ko‘ngil taomi

≈ **home-style cooking** — uyda tayyorlangan taom

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hissiy bog‘liq taom haqida: my go-to comfort food. Hisoblanmaydigan ot. Part 1 ‘favourite food’ savoliga ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Warm soup is the ultimate **comfort food** on a cold winter day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 a taste of home

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uyning ta'mi • *a food that reminds you of your home*

BAND 8 STORY
When I studied abroad, I felt homesick until my mother sent me a package of dried fruits and bread. Every bite was **a taste of home**, and I shared it with my flatmates, who loved it.

≈ **a flavour of home** — uyning mazasi

≈ **home-cooked comfort** — uy taomining iliqligi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chet elda yoki uzoqda bo'lganda, taom orqali vatanga sog'inch. Part 2 da hissiy sabab sifatida juda yaxshi: it gives me a taste of home.

Namuna gap: The little restaurant gave me **a taste of home** while I was travelling.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 bring back memories

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

xotiralarni qaytarmoq • *to make you remember things from the past*

BAND 8 STORY
The smell of plov always **brings back memories** of my grandfather's courtyard. I can see him stirring the huge kazan while the children run around, and I can hear everyone laughing.

≈ **remind me of** — menga ... ni eslatadi

≈ **take me back to** — meni o'tmishga qaytaradi

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'bring back memories (of + ot)' – hid, ta'm yoki qo'shiq esga solgani haqida. Part 2 da hissiy bog'liqlikni ko'rsatadi. 'memories' ko'plikda.

Namuna gap: The taste of this soup **brings back memories** of my school days.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 an acquired taste

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko'nikib boriladigan ta'm • *something you only start to like after trying it several times*

BAND 8 STORY
Fermented mare's milk is **an acquired taste**. The first time I tried it in the countryside I almost choked, but after a few sips I understood why people love it.

≈ **not to everyone's taste** — hamma ham yoqtirmaydi

≈ **an unusual flavour** — g'alati ta'm

Qachon ishlatiladi: Birinchi urinishda yoqmaydigan, keyin yoqadigan narsalar: be an acquired taste. Chet elliklarga milliy taom tanishtirishda foydali. Idiom.

Namuna gap: Strong cheese is **an acquired taste**, but I've grown to love it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 make my mouth water

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘zimni chuchitmoq • *to make me feel very hungry by smell or sight*

BAND 8 STORY
Even just thinking about my grandmother’s samsa **makes my mouth water**. The golden pastry, the juicy lamb and the little pieces of onion; I can almost smell it from here.

≈ **whet my appetite** — ishtahamni ochmoq

≈ **get my taste buds going** — ta’m sezgimni uyg‘otmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘make my mouth water’ – yoqimli taom haqida o‘ylaganda, ko‘rganda. Past va hozirgi zamonda. Samimiy, jonli ibora.

Namuna gap: The smell coming from the kitchen **made my mouth water**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 a hint of

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

biroz, ozgina ta’m/ishora • *a very small amount of a taste or quality*

BAND 8 STORY
The soup has **a hint of** lemon, which makes it light and fresh. I didn’t notice it at first, but once my aunt told me, I tasted it in every spoonful.

≈ **a touch of** — ozgina ta’m

≈ **a trace of** — sezilar-sezilmas iz

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(ot) maslahat, ishora — The teacher gave us **a hint** to help us solve the puzzle.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ta’m va hidni nozik tasvirlash: a hint of garlic/spice/sweetness. ‘hint’ + of + hisoblanmaydigan ot. Band 8 ta’m tavsifi uchun nozik ibora.

Namuna gap: The tea has **a hint of** mint that makes it incredibly refreshing.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 cultural heritage

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy meros • *traditions and customs inherited from past generations*

BAND 8 STORY
Food is an important part of our **cultural heritage**. Every region has its own special dish, and cooking it together keeps the history alive for young people like me.

≈ **cultural identity** — madaniy o‘ziga xoslik

≈ **national traditions** — milliy an’analar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taom madaniyat bilan bog‘liqligini aytishda: preserve/protect our cultural heritage. Rasmiy, Part 3 da juda foydali. Hisoblanmaydigan ot.

Namuna gap: Traditional dishes are part of our **cultural heritage** that we must protect.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 rooted in tradition

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

an’anaga asoslangan, ildizlari uzoqqa borgan • *strongly connected to old customs and history*

BAND 8 STORY

Plov is deeply **rooted in tradition**, and every step has a meaning. When my father cooks it for the whole neighbourhood, the men watch him in silence, as if he were performing a ritual.

≈ **steeped in history** — tarixga boy

≈ **with deep roots** — chuqur ildizlarga ega

Qachon ishlatiladi: Passiv sifat: be (deeply) rooted in tradition/culture/history. Taom, bayram yoki urf-odat haqida. Rasmiyroq, Part 2 va 3 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Their wedding customs are **rooted in tradition**, and everyone respects them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 nothing beats

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

hech narsa ... dan yaxshi emas • *nothing is better than something*

BAND 8 STORY

When it comes to a cold winter evening, **nothing beats** a bowl of steaming shurpa. The warmth spreads through your body, and for a moment all your worries just disappear.

≈ **there’s nothing like** — ...ga teng keladigani yo‘q

≈ **you can’t beat** — ...ni yengib bo‘lmaydi

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘Nothing beats + noun/-ing’ – tilning eng tabiiy so‘zlaridan. Norasmiy, ma’qullovni bildiradi. Part 1 va 2 da shaxsiy fikr uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **Nothing beats** a home-cooked meal after a long trip.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 my all-time favourite

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

mening eng sevimli taomim (har doim) • *the thing I have always liked most*

BAND 8 STORY

Manti is **my all-time favourite**, and I’ve loved it since I was a child. Each Friday my mum steams a huge tray, and I’d happily eat twenty if no one stopped me.

≈ **my number-one choice** — mening birinchi tanlovim

≈ **my go-to dish** — mening odatiy tanlovim

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘all-time favourite’ – hamma vaqtdagi eng yaxshi ko‘rgan. Part 1 ‘What is your favourite food?’ savoliga ravon javob. ‘my’ sifatdan oldin keladi.

Namuna gap: This dish has been **my all-time favourite** since I was a child.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 a labour of love

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

muhabbat bilan qilingan mehnatli ish • *a difficult task done because you really care about it*

BAND 8 STORY

Making sumalak is **a labour of love**. Women gather the night before Navruz and take turns stirring the huge pot until sunrise, singing and telling stories, and the next morning the whole street shares it.

≈ **made with great care** — katta mehr bilan qilingan

≈ **a heartfelt effort** — dildan qilingan harakat

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ko‘p vaqt va mehnat talab qiladigan, ammo sevib qilinadigan ish haqida. Idiom, Part 2 da oilaviy taomlar tavsifi uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: Baking all those cakes by hand was truly **a labour of love**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

41 culinary heritage

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

oshpazlik merosi • *the traditional cooking and food of a country or region*

BAND 8 STORY

Uzbekistan has a rich **culinary heritage**, with hundreds of regional dishes. I think schools should teach kids about it so that they appreciate what their grandparents cook.

≈ **food traditions** — ovqatlanish an'analari

≈ **traditional cuisine** — an'anaviy oshxona

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da milliy taomlar haqida rasmiy ibora: preserve/promote culinary heritage. 'cuisine' (oshxona) bilan ham ishlatiladi. Hisoblanmaydigan ot.

Namuna gap: The country is proud of its rich **culinary heritage**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 preserve traditions

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

an'analarni saqlab qolmoq • *to keep customs and practices from disappearing*

BAND 8 STORY

It is important to **preserve traditions** because they connect us with our ancestors. In my family, we still cook the same dishes at Navruz, and I plan to teach them to my own children.

≈ **keep traditions alive** — an'analarni jonli saqlamoq

≈ **safeguard customs** — urf-odatlarni himoya qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da madaniyat va yoshlar haqida: preserve/uphold traditions. Rasmiy. Qo'shimcha: 'keep tradition alive' norasmiyroq, lekin tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Young people should be encouraged to **preserve traditions** by learning old recipes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 fall out of favour

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

modadan chiqmoq, e'tibordan qolmoq • *to become less popular or less used than before*

BAND 8 STORY

Some old recipes have **fallen out of favour** because they take too long to prepare. My grandmother worries that no one will remember how to make them in twenty years.

≈ **go out of fashion** — modadan chiqmoq

≈ **become less popular** — kamroq mashhur bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Biror narsa mashhurligini yo'qotganini aytishda: fall out of favour (with + kishi). Part 3 da 'Are traditions disappearing?' savollariga tayyor ibora.

Namuna gap: Traditional dishes are in danger of **falling out of favour** among teenagers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 convenience food

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tayyor, tez tayyorlanadigan ovqat • *food that is quick and easy to prepare, often processed*

BAND 8 STORY

Busy workers rely on **convenience food** because they have no time to cook. My neighbour admitted he lives on instant noodles during the week, but he misses real home-cooked meals.

≈ **ready meals** — tayyor taomlar

≈ **processed food** — qayta ishlangan oziq-ovqat

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da zamonaviy turmush tarzi haqida: rely on/ eat convenience food. Hisoblanmaydigan ot. 'fast food' dan farqli, supermarketdagi tayyor mahsulot.

Namuna gap: The rise of **convenience food** has changed the way families eat.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 home-cooked meals

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uyda pishirilgan ovqat • *food prepared at home rather than bought outside*

BAND 8 STORY

Many families no longer have **home-cooked meals** every day. In my own house, we try to eat together at least three times a week, because it helps us stay close and healthy.

≈ **homemade dishes** — uy ovqati

≈ **meals made from scratch** — noldan tayyorlangan ovqatlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da sog'liq va oila haqida: enjoy/prepare home-cooked meals. 'home-cooked' defis bilan. Qarama-qarshi: takeaway or restaurant food.

Namuna gap: **Home-cooked meals** are usually healthier than fast food.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 a fast-paced lifestyle

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tez sur'atli hayot tarzi • *a way of living that is busy and has little free time*

BAND 8 STORY

Because of **a fast-paced lifestyle**, many people in big cities skip breakfast or eat on the go. My cousin in Tashkent says he hasn't sat at a proper dinner table for weeks.

≈ **a hectic schedule** — shoshilinch jadval

≈ **a busy way of life** — band hayot tarzi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da zamonaviy hayot sabablarini tushuntirish: lead a fast-paced lifestyle; because of the fast pace of life. Rasmiy-neytral.

Namuna gap: A **fast-paced lifestyle** leaves little time for traditional cooking.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 fusion cuisine

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

aralash (fyujn) oshxona • *cooking that combines elements from different countries*

BAND 8 STORY

Young chefs in Tashkent are experimenting with **fusion cuisine**, such as plov-stuffed burgers. At first, my father thought it was ridiculous, but after tasting it he admitted it was surprisingly good.

≈ **a blend of cuisines** — oshxonalar uyg‘unligi

≈ **mixed-style cooking** — aralash uslubdagi pazandalik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zamonaviy trend haqida: fusion cuisine/food. Part 3 da yangiliklar va an’ana o‘rtasidagi muvozanatni muhokama qilishda.

Namuna gap: **Fusion cuisine** shows how different cultures can influence each other.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 broaden my horizons

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

dunyoqarashimni kengaytirmoq • *to experience new things and learn more about the world*

BAND 8 STORY

Trying foreign dishes **broadens my horizons**. When I first ate sushi, I hated it, but later I realised that it opened my mind to different ways of thinking about food and life.

≈ **open my mind** — fikrimni kengaytirmoq

≈ **expand my knowledge** — bilimimni kengaytirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘broaden/widen your horizons’ – yangi narsa o‘rganib, dunyoqarashni boyitmoq. Part 3 da chet el taomi va sayohat haqida juda yaxshi. ‘horizons’ ko‘plikda.

Namuna gap: Travelling and tasting local food really **broadens people’s horizons**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 step out of my comfort zone

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

qulaylik doirasidan chiqmoq • *to try something new and a bit difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

I tried to **step out of my comfort zone** by ordering the most unusual dish on the menu. It turned out to be spicy fried insects, and while I didn’t love them, I was proud of myself.

≈ **try something new** — yangi narsani sinab ko‘rmoq

≈ **take a risk** — tavakkal qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi narsani sinab ko‘rish haqida: step out of your comfort zone. Part 3 da ‘Why do people try foreign food?’ uchun yaxshi. Hamma mavzularda ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Some travellers refuse to **step out of their comfort zone** when it comes to food.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 a balanced diet

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

muvozanatli ovqatlanish • *eating the right amounts of different healthy foods*

BAND 8 STORY

Traditional food can be part of **a balanced diet** if it's cooked sensibly. My doctor says I can eat plov once a week as long as I add plenty of vegetables and fresh salad.

≈ **healthy eating habits** — sog'lom ovqatlanish odatlari

≈ **a nutritious diet** — to'yimli ovqatlanish

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) ozish uchun parhez qilmoq — I'm **on a diet** this month and avoiding sugar.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da sog'liq va ovqat haqida: maintain/follow a balanced diet. 'diet' = odatiy ovqatlanish tartibi. Rasmiy-neytral.

Namuna gap: A **balanced diet** is crucial for staying healthy in the long term.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

1 It is said/believed that ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

'...deb aytiladi/hisoblanadi' (passiv xabar) • *a passive reporting structure that shares a general belief*

BAND 8 STORY

It is said that the best plov must be cooked in a cast-iron kazan over open fire. My uncle swears by this, and every wedding in our street proves him right.

≈ **It is widely believed that ...** — Keng tarqalgan fikr: ...

≈ **X is thought to be ...** — X ... deb hisoblanadi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Umumiy e'tiqod yoki an'anani rasmiyroq aytish: It is said/believed/claimed that + gap. Part 2 va 3 da faktlarni aytishda. Kim aytgani noma'lum.

Namuna gap: **It is believed that** nomads first invented this dish.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 X is widely regarded as ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

'X ... deb keng e'tirof etiladi' • *a passive structure that states a common opinion formally*

BAND 8 STORY

Plov **is widely regarded as** the king of Uzbek cuisine. Foreign visitors always want to try it, and our cooks proudly serve it in giant bowls with a piece of meat on top.

≈ **is considered to be ...** — ...deb hisoblanadi

≈ **is known as ...** — ...deb tanilgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Passiv: be (widely) regarded as + ot. Rasmiy, Part 3 va Part 2 uchun kuchli. Xato: regarded as (emas regarded to be).

Namuna gap: Samarkand bread **is widely regarded as** the best in Central Asia.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 as + adj + as / far more ... than ...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

'... kabi' / 'ancha ... dan ko'proq' (qiyoslash) • *comparisons that show equality or big difference*

BAND 8 STORY

Fast food may be tasty, but it is **far less** nutritious **than** a home-cooked meal. My mother fixes dinner with fresh vegetables, and it is **as** filling **as** anything from a restaurant.

≈ **not nearly as ... as** — ...chalik emas

≈ **considerably more ... than** — ancha ko'proq ... dan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyoslashni kuchaytirish: far/much/considerably + qiyosiy daraja + than. as...as da ikki 'as' bo'lishi kerak. Part 3 da taomlarni solishtirishda.

Namuna gap: Home cooking is **far healthier than** eating out every day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 noun + whose + noun

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

'...ning ...i' (egalik nisbiy gapi) • *a relative clause that shows who something belongs to*

BAND 8 STORY

I have an aunt **whose** plov is legendary in our family. People travel across town just to taste it, and she waves them off modestly, saying anyone can make it.

≈ **the person whose ...** — ...ning ... bo'lgan odam

≈ **a cook who ...** — ... pishiradigan oshpaz

Qachon ishlatiladi: Egalikni nisbiy gap bilan bildirish: kishi/narsa + whose + ot. 'whose' dan keyin ot majburiy. Part 2 da odamlarni tavsiflashda tabiiy eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: I know a baker **whose** bread sells out within an hour every morning.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 The reason why ... is that ...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

'... sababi shuki ...' • *a cleft-style structure that explains a cause*

BAND 8 STORY

The reason why I love this dish **is that** it brings my entire family together. When my mother cooks it, even my busy brother makes time to come home.

≈ **The main reason is that ...** — Asosiy sabab shuki ...

≈ **That is why ...** — Shuning uchun ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'The reason why ... is that' (is because emas) – Part 2 da sababni tushuntirishda. Band 8 uchun 'because' o'rniga juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **The reason why** many people love traditional food **is that** it tastes like home.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 used to / would + base verb

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

'ilgari ... qilardi' (o'tgan odat) • *structures for past habits that no longer happen*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was little, my grandmother **would** wake me up early on holidays and **used to** let me taste the dough. Those mornings in her kitchen were the happiest part of my childhood.

≈ **In those days, ...** — O'sha kunlarda ...

≈ **I remember ... -ing** — ...ni eslayman

Qachon ishlatiladi: Used to – o'tgan odat yoki holat; would – faqat takrorlanuvchi harakat (holat emas). Part 1 va 2 da bolalik haqida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: We **used to** eat dinner together every evening.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Rarely/Seldom do + S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

'Kamdan-kam hollarda ...' (inversiya) • *an inverted structure with a negative adverb for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

Rarely do young people cook traditional meals these days. Most of my friends order takeaway, and when I invited them to my place for manti, they were amazed that it was homemade.

≈ **Hardly ever ...** — Deyarli hech qachon ...

≈ **Not often ...** — Tez-tez emas ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rarely/Seldom/Never dan keyin yordamchi fe'l oldinga chiqadi: Rarely do I..., Seldom have we... Part 3 da tendentsiyalarni tasvirlash uchun juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Rarely do** families eat together on weekdays now.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Not until ... did I ...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

'Faqat ... dan keyingina ...' • *an inverted structure showing something happened only after a certain time*

BAND 8 STORY

Not until I lived abroad **did I** realise how much I missed my mother's cooking. I called her one evening, almost in tears, and asked her to teach me the recipe over video.

≈ **It was only when ... that ...** — Faqat ... paytda ...

≈ **Only after ... did ...** — Faqat ... dan keyin ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'Not until + vaqt/gap + yordamchi fe'l + S + V' – ikkinchi qismda inversiya bor, birinchisida yo'q. Part 2 da tushunish lahzasini ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **Not until** I tasted the real dish **did I** understand why people loved it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Had I known, I would have ...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

'Bilganimda edi, ... qilgan bo'lardim' • *an inverted third conditional used to talk about the past*

BAND 8 STORY

Had I known how long the dough takes to rise, I **would have** started cooking much earlier. In the end, we ate at ten at night, but my guests were so hungry that they didn't complain.

≈ **If I had known, I would have ...** — Agar bilganimda ...

≈ **Had it not been for ...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida edi ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'if' ni tushirib, Had + S + p.p., would have + p.p. – rasmiyroq va kuchliroq. O'tmishdagi afsus haqida Part 2 va 3 da.

Namuna gap: **Had I realised** how spicy it was, I **would have** asked for something milder.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 It’s high time + S + past simple

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

‘... vaqti allaqachon keldi’ • *used to say something should have happened already*

BAND 8 STORY

It’s high time we **taught** children how to cook traditional dishes. Otherwise, in a few decades, plov will be something people just order in a restaurant.

≈ **It’s about time ...** — ...vaqti bo‘ldi

≈ **We ought to ...** — Biz ... shart ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘It’s (high) time + S + o‘tgan oddiy zamon’ – hozirgi kelajak haqida, lekin fe’l o‘tgan zamonda. Fikr bildirish va tanqid qilish uchun Part 3 da juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **It’s high time** families **started** cooking together again.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Despite / In spite of + -ing

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

‘... ga qaramay’ • *prepositions of contrast followed by a noun or -ing form*

BAND 8 STORY

Despite living in a modern flat, my parents still bake non in a small clay oven on the balcony. The neighbours complain about the smoke, but my father simply smiles and invites them for a piece.

≈ **even though + S + V** — ...bo‘lsa ham

≈ **regardless of ...** — ...ga qaramay

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘Despite’ va ‘in spite of’ dan keyin -ing yoki ot keladi (S + V emas, ‘of’ qo‘shilmaydi: despite of – xato). Qarama-qarshilik uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **In spite of** being busy, she cooks a full dinner every night.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 Should you ever + V, ...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

‘Agar ... bo‘lsangiz, ...’ (inversiya) • *an inverted first conditional, formal and polite*

BAND 8 STORY

Should you ever visit Bukhara, try the local plov at a small chaikhana near the old city. The cook there uses a recipe from his grandfather, and no restaurant can compete with it.

≈ **If you happen to ...** — Agar tasodifan ...

≈ **Were you to visit ...** — Agar tashrif buyursangiz ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Should + S + base fe’l, ... = If you ... (rasmiy). Maslahat berishda yoki do‘stona taklif qilishda Part 2 va 3 da ishlatiladi. ‘will’ ishlatilmaydi.

Namuna gap: **Should you ever** come to my city, I’ll cook you a traditional dinner.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a traditional food from your country.

Describe a traditional food from your country.

You should say:

- what it is
- how it is made
- when people eat it
- why you like it

My 1-minute notes

- Plov • national dish • rice, lamb, carrots
- Kazan • fry onions • zirvak • slow cooking
- Weddings, Navruz, Thursdays • whole mahalla
- Family recipe • taste of home
- Rich in flavour • brings people together
- Pass it on • cultural heritage

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what it is)	I'd like to talk about plov, which is widely regarded as the national dish of Uzbekistan. It is basically rice cooked with lamb, carrots and onions, but to us it is far more than a meal. It's a symbol of hospitality, and every family thinks theirs is the best.
P • How it is made	As for how it is made, it is a real labour of love. First you fry onions in hot oil in a big kazan, then you add the tender meat and carrots, and let everything simmer gently to make a rich zirvak. After that, the rice goes on top, and it steams slowly for about forty minutes. Hardly had my uncle lifted the lid when the whole yard filled with the smell of cumin.
P • When people eat it	When it comes to occasions, plov is the centrepiece of the meal at weddings, funerals and holidays like Navruz. In many neighbourhoods men cook it for hundreds of guests. Besides, many families eat a lighter version every Thursday, which is a tradition passed down from generation to generation.
E • Reason 1	The first reason I love it is that it is a taste of home. Whenever I smell it cooking, it brings back memories of my grandfather's courtyard and the steam rising from the kazan, and I instantly feel safe and relaxed.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, plov brings people together. It is served on one big dish, so everyone gathers around the table and shares. What I enjoy most is the chatter and laughter that follows the first bite, because strangers soon turn into friends.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, plov is rooted in tradition and rich in flavour, and nothing beats it for me. I hope to learn my grandfather's secret recipe so that I can pass it on to my own children one day.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of...	Say...
tasty food	mouth-watering / rich in flavour
old recipe	passed down from generation to generation
I cook it myself	I make it from scratch
I felt hungry	I worked up an appetite
it reminds me of home	it brings back memories / a taste of home
traditional food is dying	falls out of favour
try new things	step out of my comfort zone
a big, satisfying meal	a hearty meal
cooked for a long time	slow-cooked
very soft in the mouth	melt in your mouth
just made bread	freshly baked
strong-smelling spices	aromatic spices
soft meat	tender meat
basic food	a staple food
a recipe nobody knows	a secret recipe
cook slowly	simmer gently
add salt as you like	season to taste
leave in sauce all night	marinate overnight
make dough	knead the dough
start eating	dig in
another portion	second helpings
a lot of food for a holiday	a festive spread
the main dish	the centrepiece of the meal
love sweet things	a sweet tooth
food that comforts	comfort food